



ITINERARY SPECIALLY PREPARED FOR TAMILNADU & KERALA



Day 01	Arrive Chennai & drive to Mahabalipuram	by International flight
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Arrive at Chennai airport in the morning

Meeting & assistance on arrival at Chennai airport and directly transfer to Mahabalipuram Enroute orientation tour of Chennai Pass by the University built in Indo-Sarascenic style, as well as 5 km long Marina Beach, a lovely esplanade by the sea.

Continue drive to Mahabalipuram

Mahabalipuram - Port of the Pallava kings in the 5th to 8th centuries. Along the shore lies a stunning series of temples and sculptures, carved from the living rock 1,200 years ago. Unlike many Hindu temples, the rocks show scenes of everyday life

On arrival, check in at hotel

Rest of day at leisure

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 02**In Mahabalipuram**

Breakfast at hotel

Morning city tour of Mahabalipuram - Visit the magnificent rock temples and carvings in Mahabalipuram. **Five Rathas (chariots) ceremonial chariots**, rock-cut monoliths, named after the 5 Pandavas - heroes of the Mahabharata epic and Draupadi their wife. **The Shore Temple** by the sea surrounded by gardens designed according to descriptions of the original layout from ancient times. Built in sandstone in the 7th century. Bhagiratha's Penance is a bas-relief (27 to 9m) sculptured on the face of two enormous adjacent rocks, depicts, the penance of Arjuna, myriad characters from the Mahabharata (a Hindu epic) with realistic life-size figures of animals, gods and saints depicting the descent of the river goddess Ganga to earth

Afternoon at leisure

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 03**Drive Mahabalipuram–Pondicherry
3 hrs drive**

Breakfast at hotel

Check out from hotel and transfer to Pondicherry

Enroute visiting Auroville- which is an experimental international township near Puducherry—differs significantly from a traditional hotel or resort stay. It is structured around sustainable living, quiet contemplation, and community-driven activities.

Experience the tranquil atmosphere of Auroville, an international experimental township dedicated to peace, sustainable living, and human unity. Begin at the Visitors Centre with an introduction to the community's philosophy and eco-initiatives, followed by a peaceful walk through shaded green pathways to the Matrimandir Viewing Point—a stunning golden dome set amidst manicured gardens designed for silent contemplation.

The central focus of Auroville is the golden-domed Matrimandir, dedicated to individual silent concentration. Your host will lead a walk through the township's green belt, explaining its founding philosophy, architectural experiments, and social initiatives.

After the visit, continue drive to Pondicherry

The last French settlement in India till 1954. Despite its invigorating seafront and relaxing atmosphere the town is visited above all for the Sri Aurobindo Ashram which draws visitors from all over the world.



Before checking into the hotel you visit Sri Aurobindo Ashram, a spiritual centre founded by Sri Aurobindo and his chief disciple Mirra Alfassa. Sri Aurobindo Ghosh was an early 20th century Bengali revolutionary and philosopher who struggled for freedom from British colonial power. He started the Ashram to put into practice his ideals of a peaceful community. In this aim he found a lifelong French companion in Mirra Alfassa, who became universally known as the Mother. After his death the Mother continued as the spiritual successor and charismatic figure of Pondicherry.

Stroll through the streets whose names still bear the French influence and finally to Auroville, "city of dawn", founded in 1968 and is inhabited by about 1000 people who are from 20 different countries.

On arrival, Check-In at hotel

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 04	In Pondicherry
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Breakfast at hotel

Morning visit Aurobindo Ashram which was, founded by Sri Aurobindo a onetime Bengal evolutionary who later took to the spiritual path & Auroville, the city of Dawn was started in Feb. 1968 as a unique experiment in international living, where people live and work in total harmony.

Sri Aurobindo Ashram: The Sri Aurobindo Ashram located on rue de la Marine, is one of the most well-known and wealthiest ashrams in India, with devotees from India and all over the world flocking to it for spiritual salvation. Its spiritual tenets represent a synthesis of yoga and modern science. (*Children below 3 years of age are not allowed into the ashram*)

Continue visit to one of famous local market i.e. **Goubert Market with cup of Masala Chai**, also known as the Grand Bazaar, is a century-old wholesale market located at the edge of the French Quarter in Pondicherry. Named after Édouard Goubert, the first Chief Minister of Pondicherry, this lively and no-frills market serves as a sensory gateway into the town's daily life, where local restaurants and residents gather early each morning for fresh raw ingredients. The market is distinctly organized into a kaleidoscope of sections, including a vibrant flower lane fragrant with jasmine and marigold garlands, a bustling produce and spice wing, and a famous wet fish market entirely managed and run by local women selling fresh catches from the Bay of Bengal.



Late afternoon we arrange cycle rickshaw ride to French quarters

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 05	Drive to Tanjore 185 kms/4 hrs drive
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Breakfast at hotel

Check Out & drive to Kumbakonam

Enroute visiting Chidambaram – visiting Thillai Nataraja Temple, Chidambaram, where you can admire its gold-plated roof, intricate dance postures on the towering gateways, and the sacred sanctuary of the Chidambaram Rahasyam.

After above visit, continue drive to Tanjore

Tanjore, or Thanjavur as it was earlier called, was the capital of the Chola Empire from the 10th century to the 14th century A.D. later is become part of the Vijaynagar kingdom, then passed into the hands of the Marathas and later still went to the British. For ages it has been the chief political, literary and religious centre of the South. The celebrated temple Brihadeshwara built by the Chola King during the 11th century is its major attraction.

On arrival, check in at hotel

Afternoon proceed for visiting **Sri Brihadishwara Temple**



Visit **Sri Brihadishwara Temple** This is also called the big temple and it is dedicated to Lord Shiva. The great Chola king Raja Raja I (985-1012 A.D) built this temple. It is an outstanding example of the Chola architecture. Its unique architectural excellence has made the UNESCO to declare it a World Heritage Monument. The 64.8mts.Tall **vimanam** or the tower over the **sanctum sanctorum** is a testimony to the engineering skill of the Cholas. In keeping the immensity of the temple the gigantic **mahalingam** in the shrine measures 4 Mtrs. in height. The monolithic Nandi or the bull mount of Lord Shiva has been chiselled out of single rock. It is the second largest Nandi in India. The beautiful Chola Fresco paintings on the inner walls of the temple are no way less than Ajanta paintings

Later explore local markets of Tanjore

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 06	Drive to Chettinad Via Trichy
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Breakfast at hotel
Check Out & further drive to Chettinad

Enroute visiting Trichy- **Tiruchirappalli**, citadel of the early Chola rulers which later fell to the Pallavas kings. On arrival visit **the Srirangam Temple**, constructed in the Dravidian style of architecture and the Rock-Fort Temple, landmark of Trichy).

Also visit the Kaveri Ghat to witness prayer ceremony

After visit, continue drive to Chettinad via Karaikudi where you will visit Brothers of Charity.

***Chettinad** is world-famous for its palatial 19th-century merchant mansions, vibrant local crafts, and iconic spicy regional cuisine. Built by the wealthy Nattukottai Chettiars—seafaring traders and financiers—these grand residences blend traditional South Indian courtyard designs with global architectural elements*

Upon arrival, check in at hotel

Evening at leisure

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 07	Drive to Madurai 2-3 hrs drive
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Breakfast at hotel

Morning visit Chettinad Palace, various mansion & Museum

Further check out & drive to Madurai

Madurai - The cultural capital of Tamilnadu. Here, the Dravidian culture reached its zenith in art, architecture, palaces and temple buildings. Once the capital of powerful Nayaka kings, a bustling city packed with pilgrims, businessmen, bullock carts and legions of rickshaw pullers. Its narrow overcrowded streets seem to be bursting at the seams with activity. Southern India's oldest center for pilgrimage and learning.

On arrival, Check in at hotel

Late evening witness Night ceremony at Meenakshi Temple_- Enjoy a short transfer by Tuk-Tuks

In the late evening, enjoy a short, spirited ride through the bustling streets of Madurai aboard traditional auto-rickshaws (Tuk-Tuk) to reach the magnificent Madurai Meenakshi Sundareswarar Temple. Here, you will witness the enchanting Palliyarai Pooja—the grand night ceremony that marks the end of the temple day. Accompanied by the resonant strains of the nadaswaram pipe, the thunder of temple drums, and Vedic chanting, priests carry the bronze image of Lord Sundareswarar (Shiva) in a ornate silver palanquin to the bedchamber of Goddess Meenakshi. Surrounded by the scent of camphor, jasmine, and incense smoke beneath towering, illuminated Gopuram, this mesmerizing spectacle offers an unforgettable glimpse into South India's living temple traditions.

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 08**In Madurai****Visit to Flower market in the early morning**

At dawn, head out for a vibrant early morning walk through the bustling local flower market to watch the city gradually come to life. As the first light filters through the stalls, witness local vendors artfully weaving fragrant garlands of fresh marigolds, jasmine, and roses amid a lively kaleidoscope of colors and activity. Observe the energetic morning routine of local traders and early-bird shoppers before pausing to savor a piping-hot cup of traditional chai served in a classic clay cup (kulhad), offering a quiet moment to soak in the authentic morning atmosphere before returning to your hotel for breakfast

Breakfast at hotel

Later proceed for city tour to Madurai - Visit the *Thirumalai Nayak Palace*, a palace in Indo-Saracenic style built in 1636, with huge domes and 240 columns rising to 12 m, a beautiful garden and a attached museum. The celestial Pavilion, an arcaded octagonal structure is curiously constructed in brick and mortar without any supporting rafters.

Also visit Meenakshi Temple, an outstanding example of the Dravidian temple architecture from the Vijaynagar kingdom. Meenakshi, the fish eyed goddess and the consort of Shiva has a temple to the south and Sundareswarar (Shiva) a temple to the west. One of the biggest temples of India. Its nine "Gopuram"-Temple towers (23-30m) have wonderful stucco images of gods, goddesses and animals from the Hindu mythology.

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel**Day 09****Drive Madurai-Munnar
3 hrs drive**

Breakfast at hotel

Check out from hotel & drive to Munnar

Munnar - One of the most popular hill stations in India, Munnar is situated at the confluence of three mountain streams - Mudrapuzha, Nallathanni and Kundala. Located at 1600 Mts above sea level, this was once the summer resort of the erstwhile British Government in South India. Sprawling tea plantations, picture book towns, winding lanes, trekking and holiday facilities make Munnar a unique experience. Munnar is essentially a tea town. The tea plantations have now been taken over by the Tata Tea Company. The visitor is greeted with miles and miles of unending tea plantations on entry into Munnar.



Upon arrival in Munnar, **proceed to visit a tea garden and tea museum** to discover the craft behind India's world-renowned teas. Walk through the lush, scenic plantations before stepping inside the operational factory to observe the full production cycle—from the precise plucking of tender leaves to rolling, drying, and grading. At the museum, explore historic machinery, vintage photographs, and artefacts that trace the region's rich tea-plantation heritage, concluding with a curated tasting session to sample freshly brewed local varieties.

Later visit the Srishti TATA project (Srishti is closed on weekends and holidays). This project is a Tata Global Beverages project for the rehabilitation of people with disabilities. Enjoy a shopping spree at this community center - strawberry jam (handmade), handmade paper or clothes dyed naturally on site

Further check in at hotel

Rest of time at leisure

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 10	Drive Munnar-Periyar 4-5 hrs drive
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Breakfast at hotel

Check Out & drive to Periyar - Upon arrival, check in at hotel



Afternoon boat ride by private boat on Lake Periyar, which carry you through the jungle with the possibility of sighting of elephant, bison, deer and occasionally, tiger. Small animals include black Nilgiri langur; bonnet and lion tailed macaque, Giant and Flying squirrel. There are some 246 species of birds and 112 species of butterfly. There are trees more than 100 years old and over 50 m high.

In the evening witness a performance of Kalaripayatu – the Martial Arts of Kerala
Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 11

In Periyar

Breakfast at hotel

Proceed to Nature walk through jungles along with English speaking naturalist – *Whispering winds in the canopy of green leaves; birds calling all around in a mixed flock; butterflies floating away through the enchanting greenery. You may come across anything on the trail even a lone animal moving silently. Nature amazes you through many of its mysterious expression. Different nature trails traversing diverse habitats form the trekking routes, generally 4 to 5 km. in length. This is an interpretive programme offering excellent opportunity to watch birds, butterflies and other wildlife. The trails often pass through evergreen and moist deciduous forests interspersed with marshy grasslands. (Duration of this activity – approx 3 hrs.)*

Later return to hotel for breakfast

Afternoon visit the spice plantation in Thekkady is one of the major spice plantations in Kerala & captivating farms to wander in, since different spices are cultivated in different sections of each plantation.

Accompanied by an expert naturalist, wander through systematically organized sections where exotic spices such as cardamom, black pepper, cinnamon, nutmeg, vanilla, and cloves are cultivated in their natural habitat. Along the way, discover the rich agricultural history, traditional harvesting techniques, and therapeutic uses of these spices, while enjoying the refreshing, spice-scented mountain air.

Later enjoy free time in local market of Periyar town
Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 12**Drive Periyar-Kumarakom
3-4 hrs drive**

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel and drive to Kumarakom via Kottayam – renowned as Kerala's gateway to religious harmony and heritage. En route, explore Kottayam's rich spiritual tapestry, starting with the 16th-century **Thirunakkara Mahadeva Temple**, a masterpiece of traditional Kerala architecture featuring sloping wooden roofs, intricate epic murals, and a grand Koothambalam (dance hall). Continue to the ancient banks of Thazhathangady to visit **St. Mary's Knanaya Valiyapally** (built in 1550 AD), famous for its rare 8th-century granite Persian Crosses inscribed in Pahlavi script, and the nearby **St. Mary's Cheriapally** (1579 AD), which houses exquisite biblical ceiling murals blending European and Oriental art styles.

Following these insightful cultural visits, continue your scenic drive to the serene backwaters of Kumarakom.



Kumarakom: The village of Kumarakom is a cluster of little islands on the Vembanad Lake in Kerala, a state in India. Geographically, it is located at 9.35 North and 76.26 East. Kumarakom's soil is extremely fertile due to the proximity of the water source, this has resulted in the growth of a wide variety of flora in Kumarakom, especially the mangrove and coconut trees. Vembanad Lake is home to several types of marine life exclusively the 'Karimeen' (Pearl Spotted Fish), the 'Chemeen' (Prawns) and the 'Konju' (Tiger Prawns).

Check in at hotel

Afternoon visit Responsible tourism initiatives taken by local authorities/government to support the communities by doing different activities Country Boat, Toddy taping, witness the true skills of catching fish, coir processing & other local activities. This tour will take around 3 hrs in total

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 13**Kumarakom -Alleppey****Breakfast at hotel****Thereafter, Embark to Houseboat**

Long Ago there were wooden barges in the Back Water area to convey Rice Coir and Coconut from one village to another. The rice boat takes you through the Back Waters where you can walk through the water logged villages and experience the breath taking beauty.

**Hot Lunch on board**

Sail through the backwaters to view rural life in Kerala - At sunset, the house boat drops anchor at the banks of the lake

Dinner & overnight on board**Day 14****Alleppey-Cochin
60 minutes' drive****Breakfast on board****Dis embark from houseboat & drive to Cochin**

Kochi (Cochin): With its wealth of historical associations and its beautiful setting on a cluster of islands and narrow peninsulas, the interesting city of Kochi reflects the eclecticism of Kerala perfectly. Here , you can see the oldest churches in India, winding streets crammed with 500 years-old Portuguese houses , cantilevered Chinese fishing nets, a Jewish community whose roots go back to the Diaspora, 16th century synagogue , a palace built by the Portuguese, (later renovated by the Dutch).



The older parts of Fort Cochin and Mattancherry are an unlikely blend of medieval Portugal, Holland and an English country village grafted onto the tropical Malabar Coast. Kochi is also one of India's largest ports.

Upon arrival, proceed for city tour of Cochin especially Fort Cochin area which is believed to be the oldest European settlement in India – **Visit the Chinese fishing nets;** *one of the fascinating attractions of Kerala. Their beauty is attributed to their size, elegant construction and the way they work. The Chinese fishing nets are popularly known as Cheenavala in Kerala, & St. Francis Church;* *the first European Church to be built in India. The history of this Church reflects the colonial struggle of European powers in India, from the 15th to 20th Centuries*

Further visit to the satellite towns of Kochi (Cochin) - Comprises visits to the Jew town & Synagogue **(Closed on every Friday & Saturday)**, Dutch Palace **(Closed on every Friday)** Portuguese Architecture and British Influences, all blending harmoniously with the basic Kerala heritage testify that the rulers of Cochin traded goods as well as knowledge with the visitors from far off lands.

Late afternoon Witness Kathakali dance show in a Theatre

Kathakali classical dance of Kerala owes its transnational fame to the nearly 300-year-old. Kathakali literally means story-play and is an elaborate dance depicting the victory of truth over falsehood. Themes revolve around the two great epics, the Ramayana and the Mahabharata. A Striking feature of Kathakali is the use of elaborate make-up and colorful costumes. This is to emphasize that the characters are super beings from another world. The spectators can feel his invisible presence when the heroine or her maid details dreams and ambitions through circular movements, delicate footsteps and subtle expressions. Through slow and medium tempos, the dancer is able to find adequate space for improvisations and suggestive bhavas or emotions. Costume is designed with lots of paint applied on the face of the artist. The pomp and magnificence of Kathakali is partly due to its decor, part of which include the 'Kireetam' or huge head gear, the 'Kanchukam' or the oversized jacket, and the long skirt worn over a thick padding of cushions.



In the evening, step into a local home for an intimate cultural exchange and culinary experience. Begin with lively discussions with your host family, gaining personal insights into Kerala's rich heritage and daily life. Afterward, participate in a live cooking demonstration showcasing quintessential Kerala specialties, followed by a delicious, authentic home-cooked dinner enjoyed together with the family.

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 15

**Fly Out from Cochin
by International flight**

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out & transfer to International airport to connect flight for onward destination

=====END OF OUR SERVICES=====

Check-in at hotel is 1400 hrs // Check-out time is 12 noon at all the hotels